

LIZARDFOLK: THE THREE CASTES



LIZARDFOLK: THE THREE CASTES IS A MONSTER supplement for 5e that presents lizardfolk society as a biologically structured species rather than a loose tribal archetype. Instead of treating lizardfolk as generic swamp warriors, this book explores a rigid developmental system in which young lizardfolk are evaluated and assigned to one of three castes based on measurable traits: the Predator caste, the Logical caste, and the Brood caste.

The intent of this product is mechanical clarity and encounter variety without CR inflation. The ladder begins with shared early-life roles representing hatchlings and adolescents before caste assignment, then branches into three specialized paths. Each caste emphasizes a distinct battlefield identity, allowing encounters to feel coordinated, purposeful, and biologically structured rather than random collections of monsters.

Cultural lore, motive, and political interpretation are intentionally minimal. Whether this caste system is ancient instinct, ritual tradition, or deliberate social engineering is left to the GM. These stat blocks present a functioning ecological hierarchy. Why it exists, and whether it can change, is yours to decide.

THE PREDATOR CASTE

Predator-caste lizardfolk are selected for physical dominance and hunting instinct. They serve as the primary hunters, enforcers, and expansion forces of a tribe. Strength, endurance, and combat success determine their advancement, and hierarchy among them is often established through direct displays of dominance.

Predator encounters emphasize aggression, pack coordination, and decisive combat pressure. These warriors advance quickly, overwhelm targets through coordinated attacks, and rely on physical superiority rather than subtle tactics. A predator-caste warband feels dangerous, immediate, and relentless.

THE LOGICAL CASTE

Logical-caste lizardfolk are identified for analytical thinking and strategic awareness. They serve as planners, observers, and battlefield coordinators responsible for directing hunts, migrations, and large-scale conflict.

Logical encounters emphasize positioning, command abilities, and battlefield manipulation. Rather than overwhelming foes through raw strength, they guide the

flow of combat by improving allied coordination and disrupting enemy momentum. A logical-caste force feels deliberate and calculating, shaping the battlefield through organization rather than brute force.

THE BROOD CASTE

Brood-caste lizardfolk are selected for stability, resilience, and protective instincts. Their responsibility is continuity: defending hatcheries, protecting eggs, and maintaining the physical security of the tribe's future.

Brood encounters emphasize defensive formations, damage interception, and territorial protection. These warriors anchor positions and create fortified defensive lines around nests and brood chambers. A brood-caste force feels immovable and determined, prioritizing protection and survival above all else.

PREDATOR CASTE

LIZARDFOLK PACK ENFORCER

Medium humanoid (lizardfolk), unaligned

Armor Class 16 (natural hide, shield)

Hit Points 60 (8d8 + 24)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Skills Athletics +5, Perception +3, Survival +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Draconic

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Amphibious. This lizardfolk can breathe air and water.

Pack Pressure. This lizardfolk has advantage on melee attack rolls against a creature if at least one allied lizardfolk is within 5 feet of the target and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Predator Momentum. If this lizardfolk hits the same creature with two melee attacks in the same turn, the target must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This lizardfolk makes two attacks.

War Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. range 20/60 ft, one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

REACTIONS

Pack Intercept. When a creature within 5 feet of this lizardfolk targets another allied lizardfolk with an attack, this lizardfolk can impose disadvantage on the attack roll.

- Pack enforcers are the first members of the predator caste, enforcing dominance and discipline within hunting groups.
- They coordinate attacks with nearby predators, focusing on overwhelming a single target.
- Enforcers press forward aggressively but withdraw if the pack collapses.



LIZARDFOLK WAR COORDINATOR

Medium humanoid (lizardfolk), unaligned

Armor Class 15 (natural hide)

Hit Points 88 (16d8 + 16)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Int +6, Wis +5

Skills Insight +5, Perception +5, Survival +5

Senses passive Perception 15

Languages Draconic

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Amphibious. This lizardfolk can breathe air and water.

Battlefield Calculation. The first time each round that an allied lizardfolk within 30 feet hits a creature, that attack deals an extra 4 (1d8) damage.

Strategic Positioning. Allied lizardfolk within 20 feet of this lizardfolk ignore difficult terrain caused by mud, shallow water, or natural wetlands.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This lizardfolk makes two attacks.

Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. range 20/60 ft, one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) piercing damage.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Reposition Unit. One allied lizardfolk within 30 feet that can hear this lizardfolk can move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

REACTIONS

Predictive Defense. When a creature this lizardfolk can see hits an allied lizardfolk within 20 feet, the damage is reduced by 5 (1d10).

- War coordinators rarely attack first; they focus on controlling positioning and battlefield momentum.
- They remain near the center of allied formations where their commands affect the most warriors.
- Eliminating a coordinator often causes nearby lizardfolk units to lose tactical cohesion.



LIZARDFOLK SOVEREIGN OF THE DEEP NEST

Medium humanoid (lizardfolk), unaligned

Armor Class 18 (natural hide, shield)

Hit Points 136 (16d8 + 64)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Con +7, Wis +6

Skills Athletics +7, Insight +6, Perception +6

Senses passive Perception 16

Languages Draconic

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Amphibious. This lizardfolk can breathe air and water.

Brood Authority. Allied brood-caste lizardfolk within 30 feet of this lizardfolk gain a +2 bonus to AC while they are within 5 feet of another allied lizardfolk.

Nestbound Resolve. This lizardfolk has advantage on saving throws against being frightened or charmed.

Protect the Future (1/Round). When an allied lizardfolk within 20 feet would be reduced to 0 hit points, this lizardfolk can allow that creature to drop to 1 hit point instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This lizardfolk makes three attacks: two with its spear and one with its bite.

War Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. range 20/60 ft, one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 4) piercing damage.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage.

REACTIONS

Shield the Brood. When an allied lizardfolk within 10 feet is hit by an attack, the damage is reduced by 8 (1d12 + 2).

- The sovereign of the deep nest commands brood defenders and determines the survival priorities of the tribe.
- It rarely leaves hatchery territory unless the entire tribe migrates.
- If a sovereign falls, brood caste defenders often fight with reckless desperation.



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